

Abdullah Al Zahid

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Talent Acquisition

Capital Projects Group — Rapid Transit Program Delivery
Metrolinx, 10 Bay Street

Re: Manager, Rapid Transit Program Delivery (Job ID 117264)

Dear Hiring Manager,

I would like to be considered for the Manager, Rapid Transit Program Delivery position with the Capital Projects Group. I worked at Metrolinx through 2023 in the Service Design office, and my current work with the City of Toronto sits at the point where new development meets existing and planned infrastructure, which is much of what the Transit Oriented Community side of this role is about.

That is the part of the posting I recognise most closely: making sure a developer's proposal accounts for the infrastructure around and beneath it, and that the owner's requirements are written into what gets built. As an Assistant Planner I review development applications, engineering submissions and consultant drawings for their effect on existing and planned infrastructure, and recommend conditions where something is missing. I have not prepared a Metrolinx Asset Protection Package, but reading a submission against what has to be protected, and setting out plainly what needs to change, is the everyday substance of my work.

The posting also asks for someone who can work with partners on sensitive issues and report clearly to management. At the City I coordinate with divisions, consultants, applicants and outside agencies whose priorities often conflict, and I write the memos and briefing notes that carry those issues upward. At Metrolinx my work was establishing what slow orders and other operating changes would do to service before they were taken forward, and a short placement with Mott MacDonald on Ontario Line work involved simulating how construction staging would affect the surrounding streets.

I should be straightforward about the gaps. The posting asks for at least eight years of relevant experience and I have closer to four. I have not supervised staff, held a project budget, taken a project through a system safety review, or negotiated agreements with the TTC, and I do not hold a P.Eng. or PMP. I am applying because the development interface work is familiar to me, and because the posting invites people who do not meet every requirement. If this role is a step too far, I would welcome being considered for a project-level position within the Rapid Transit program.

Thank you for taking the time to consider my application.

Sincerely,

Abdullah Al Zahid

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